Coarse information and finite rank obstructions for flat lattice Hodge forms

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Abstract

On a finite periodic lattice with unit spacing, a flat Hodge form cannot have a positive coercivity constant uniform under refinement if it is supplemented only by observations in a fixed finite-dimensional space and uniformly bounded rank fine-space repairs. The observations may vary arbitrarily with the refinement, and their penalty need only vanish at zero. We prove the same obstruction directly on kernels of uniformly bounded rank constraints. The proof constructs a real physical Fourier subspace of dimension $2(2R+1)^d$ with Hodge energy at most $4\pi^2 dR^2/n^2$ times its squared norm. Its intersection with the unobserved directions gives a necessary rank budget. We also explain why this budget is not sufficient, using a two-dimensional cross-coupling example and a classical complete criterion for a fixed map. The Fourier construction, finite budget, and uniform obstructions have Lean proofs; the fixed-map criterion is an analytic result here. These are finite flat statements, with no interacting or continuum mass-gap claim.

1 Purpose and relation to the existing record

This text consolidates a continuation of the exact-kernel obstruction in [1]. That paper exhibits fields in the kernel of a particular line-integral block map. Changing the map can remove a particular witness. Here the obstruction depends instead on the amount of coarse information: a whole low-energy subspace is too large to be seen by a fixed-dimensional measurement together with a bounded-rank repair. The map need not factor through the original block variable, be local, or obey a norm bound. The restricted-sector result is proved separately and does not follow merely from failure of an estimate on the full space.

Fourier diagonalization, rank-nullity and finite-dimensional Schur complements are classical. Finite-difference Hodge theory has a long history; Dodziuk's work [2] provides historical context, rather than this paper's specific lattice normalization. We make no claim to a new general spectral principle or an exhaustive priority search. The contribution is a concrete, reproducibly checked constraint on proposed repair routes in this programme. This consolidation is intended for the existing paper dossier, rather than an additional deposit for each lemma.

2 Spaces and the actual flat form

Fix integers $d \geq 1$, $n \geq 1$ and $N_c \geq 2$. Set $X_n = (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^d$ and $m = N_c^2 - 1$. The real one-cochain space is

$$E_n = \{A : X_n \times \{1, \dots, d\} \longrightarrow \mathbb{R}^m\}, \qquad \|A\|^2 = \sum_{x \in X_n} \sum_{i=1}^{d} \|A_i(x)\|^2.$$

The internal coordinates are those of the repository's Euclidean Lie-coordinate model. No identification with a matrix Lie algebra is required here. For positive unordered plaquettes $i < k$, define

$$(\mathrm{d}A)_{ik}(x) = A_k(x+e_i) - A_k(x) - A_i(x+e_k) + A_i(x),$$
$$(\delta A)(x) = \sum_i (A_i(x) - A_i(x-e_i)).$$

The flat operator $K_{0,n}$ is the actual repository Hodge operator, with

$$\langle A, K_{0,n} A\rangle = \|\mathrm{d}A\|^2 + \|\delta A\|^2. \tag{1}$$

The plaquette norm sums each pair once. All differences have unit spacing; there is no hidden n^2 or block-side squared factor.

Choose a direction j and two distinct internal unit coordinates u, v. They exist since $m \geq 3$. For $f : X_n \to \mathbb{C}$, put

$$(E_j f)_i(x) = \begin{cases} (\Re f(x))u + (\Im f(x))v, & i = j, \\ 0, & i \neq j. \end{cases}$$

This is a real-linear injection and $\|E_j f\|^2 = \sum_x |f(x)|^2$. Writing $D_i f(x) = f(x+e_i) - f(x)$, the actual curl and divergence give

$$\langle E_j f, K_{0,n} E_j f\rangle = \sum_{i\neq j}\sum_x |D_i f(x)|^2 + \sum_x |f(x) - f(x-e_j)|^2 = \sum_i \sum_x |D_i f(x)|^2. \tag{2}$$

The last equality is finite translation invariance. The exclusive two plaquette incidences and the divergence term account for every direction exactly once, with no extra factor two.

3 A constructed low band

For $R \geq 0$ with $2R < n$, let $\Lambda_R = \{-R, \ldots, R\}^d$ and $B = |\Lambda_R| = (2R+1)^d$. Define

$$\chi_k(x) = \exp(2\pi \mathrm{i}\, k \cdot x/n), \qquad f_a = \sum_{k\in\Lambda_R} a_k \chi_k, \qquad S_R = \{E_j f_a : a \in \mathbb{C}^{\Lambda_R}\} \subset E_n.$$

Lemma 3.1. *The real subspace S_R has dimension $2B$, and for every $A \in S_R$,*

$$\langle A, K_{0,n} A\rangle \leq b_R(n)\|A\|^2, \qquad b_R(n) = \frac{4\pi^2 d R^2}{n^2}. \tag{3}$$

Proof. For $k, \ell \in \Lambda_R$, the product root-of-unity sum is $\sum_x \overline{\chi_k(x)}\chi_\ell(x) = n^d \mathbf{1}_{k=\ell}$. The no-alias condition ensures that coordinate differences, of absolute value at most $2R < n$, cannot be nonzero multiples of n. Thus synthesis is injective and its complex image has dimension B. As a real space that image has dimension $2B$; applying the real-linear injection E_j preserves dimension. The factor two represents independent real and imaginary coefficients stored in two real internal coordinates, not two copies of a real scalar band.

For completeness, energy orthogonality is needed as well as mass orthogonality. For each i,

$$D_i f_a = \sum_k a_k (e^{2\pi \mathrm{i} k_i/n} - 1)\chi_k.$$

Applying the same Gram sum to these derivative amplitudes gives

$$\|E_j f_a\|^2 = n^d \sum_k |a_k|^2,$$
$$\langle E_j f_a, K_{0,n} E_j f_a \rangle = n^d \sum_k |a_k|^2 \sum_i |e^{2\pi i k_i/n} - 1|^2.$$

Since $|e^{it} - 1| \le |t|$ and $|k_i| \le R$, each sum of multipliers is at most $4\pi^2 dR^2/n^2$. This proves the bound for every member of the constructed image, not only its individual generators. □

4 The finite information budget

Let F be a finite-dimensional real vector space, $C : E_n \to F$ a linear measurement and $V : E_n \to E_n$ a linear operator. No symmetry or positivity of V is needed. Let $\Phi : F \to \mathbb{R}$ be any function with $\Phi(0) = 0$.

Theorem 4.1. *If $c > b_R(n)$ and*

$$c\|A\|^2 \le \langle A, K_{0,n} A \rangle + \Phi(CA) + \langle A, VA \rangle \quad \textit{for all } A \in E_n, \tag{4}$$

then $2(2R+1)^d \le \dim F + \operatorname{rank} V$.

Proof. If the budget is smaller than $\dim S_R$, restrict the map (C, V) to S_R. Its image has dimension at most $\dim F + \operatorname{rank} V$. Rank-nullity yields a nonzero $A \in S_R$ with $CA = VA = 0$. Equation (4) and Lemma 3.1 imply $c\|A\|^2 \le b_R(n)\|A\|^2$, a contradiction. □

The codomain dimension is a conservative measurement budget. We do not label this formal endpoint as a sharper theorem with $\operatorname{rank} C$ in its place. No regularity, sign, polynomial form or growth restriction on Φ enters.

Proposition 4.2. *If $P : E_n \to E_n$ is linear, $c > b_R(n)$ and $\dim F + \operatorname{rank} P < 2(2R+1)^d$, the inequality*

$$c\|A\|^2 \le \langle A, K_{0,n} A \rangle + \Phi(CA) \qquad (A \in \ker P)$$

is false.

Proof. Apply the same rank-nullity argument to $(C, P)|_{S_R}$. Its nonzero kernel vector belongs to the stipulated sector as well as the unobserved band. □

For example, $d = 4, n = 16, R = 1$ gives dimension 162 and $b_R(n) = \pi^2/16 < 1$. Twelve measurement coordinates and a repair of rank at most 149 cannot yield (4) with $c = 1$. This illustrates a necessary budget, not the programme's chosen target constant.

5 Uniform refinement and sector exclusion

Fix $N' \ge 1$ and put $n_L = (L+1)N'$ for $L \ge 0$. The finite-dimensional space F is fixed. Allow arbitrary families $C_L : E_{n_L} \to F$, $\Phi_L : F \to \mathbb{R}$ with $\Phi_L(0) = 0$, and $V_L : E_{n_L} \to E_{n_L}$ with $\operatorname{rank} V_L \le r$ for one fixed integer r.

Theorem 5.1. *There is no $c > 0$ for which (4) holds for every L and every $A \in E_{n_L}$ with these families. Likewise, for linear P_L of rank at most r, there is no positive uniform c for the sector estimates of Proposition 4.2 on all* $\ker P_L$.

Proof. Set $M = \dim F$ and $R = M + r + 1$. Since $d \geq 1$, $2(2R+1)^d > M + r$. Choose L so large that $2R < n_L$ and $b_R(n_L) < c$. Here is a fully finite choice argument, without an assumed limit theorem: with $a = 4\pi^2 dR^2$, take an integer $L > \max\{2R, a/c, 1\}$. Since $N' \geq 1$, $n_L \geq L + 1 > L > 1$, and $a < cL \leq cn_L^2$. Theorem 4.1 now contradicts the rank bound. Use Proposition 4.2 for the separate sector conclusion. □

The constants c, r precede the quantifier over L. Arbitrary rescalings of C_L preserve its fixed codomain and do not escape the theorem. Removing harmonic or constant directions is covered only when a concrete linear constraint describing the proposed sector has uniformly bounded rank. A quotient or its norm is not silently identified with such a sector.

6 Why dimension is not a sufficiency criterion

The following analytic statement is included to prevent the reverse inference from a necessary rank budget. It is not a new Lean-verified endpoint here. Let E be a finite-dimensional real inner-product space, $H = H^*$ and $B = H - cI$. Fix linear $C : E \to F$, and decompose $E = N \oplus W$ with $N = \ker C$, $W = N^\perp$. In this decomposition write

$$B = \begin{pmatrix} A & D \\ D^* & G \end{pmatrix}.$$

Proposition 6.1. *A finite real-valued function Φ with $\Phi(0) = 0$ can make $\langle x, Bx\rangle + \Phi(Cx) \geq 0$ for every x if and only if $A \succeq 0$ and* $\ker A \subseteq \ker D^*$. *In that event a quadratic penalty suffices.*

Proof. Taking $x \in N$ proves $A \succeq 0$. For $z \in \ker A$ and fixed $w \in W$, the value at $tz + w$ contains $2t\langle z, Dw\rangle$, while $C(tz + w) = Cw$ is fixed. Boundedness below for all real t forces this coefficient to vanish.

Conversely, $\ker A \subseteq \ker D^*$ implies $D(W) \subseteq \operatorname{ran} A$. Let $A^\dagger$ be the inverse on $\operatorname{ran} A$ and zero on $\ker A$. Completing the square gives

$$\langle n + w, B(n + w)\rangle = \langle n + A^\dagger Dw, A(n + A^\dagger Dw)\rangle + \langle w, (G - D^* A^\dagger D)w\rangle.$$

The restriction $C|_W$ is injective; extend its inverse on $C(W)$ to a linear map $T : F \to W$. The quadratic function $\Phi(y) = \langle Ty, (D^* A^\dagger D - G)Ty\rangle$ cancels the second term and vanishes at zero. If F has a chosen Euclidean norm, a sufficiently large nonnegative multiple of $\|y\|^2$ also suffices, by finite-dimensional norm bounds. □

For a concrete counterexample let $H = \operatorname{diag}(0, 2)$, $c = 1$ and $C(x, y) = x + y$. On $\ker C$, $\langle x, (H - I)x\rangle = 0$, and C detects the negative eigendirection of $H - I$. Nevertheless, on $(t, 1 - t)$ the repaired form is $1 - 2t + \Phi(1)$, unbounded below for every finite $\Phi(1)$. Kernel nonnegativity and low-mode detection alone do not suffice; cross-coupling must be checked.

7 Operator scaling and the actual consumer

In the repository, the flat fixed-volume covariance endpoint uses $K_0 + aQ^*Q$ with the physical counting ℓ^2 norm and the same unscaled flat Hodge operator. Its coercivity constant is $\min(1, a)/C_P$, with C_P from the full-periodic block-Poincare estimate. At fixed d, N_c, N' the block codomain is fixed and finite. Inspection therefore identifies the unscaled flat base route with the setting of Theorem 5.1, with $\Phi_L(y) = a_L\|y\|^2$ and no fine repair. Even allowing arbitrary scalar a_L or rescaling Q_L does not yield a positive uniform full-space constant. This is a source-level specialization in this text; no new Lean adapter to that consumer is claimed.

The inspected endpoint is explicitly fixed-volume. Its positive rate may depend on L, N' and C_P, so there is no contradiction. Nor does the obstruction exclude all possible uniform Combes–Thomas arguments. Its locality radius and matrix-entry bounds also vary with L; coercivity alone would not settle the rate. An interacting Hessian, a growing measurement budget, a different sector norm or a physically rescaled operator must each be audited separately.

In particular, writing $\ell = L + 1$ so that $n_L = \ell N'$, replacing K_0 by $\ell^2 K_0$ changes the band threshold exactly to $4\pi^2 dR^2/(N')^2$. The proof above no longer drives it below every fixed $c > 0$. This observation is an escape from this proof, not an established coercivity theorem for the programme's physical operator. No ultraviolet activity estimate, continuum limit, Wilson-Hessian identification or Yang–Mills mass gap is obtained.

8 Formal evidence and publication context

The source-tree anchor containing all formal results used above is

`e31b428917aa767b4a1aad097db5cf92fb9cd23e`.

The geometric and Fourier modules are ordinary proof dependencies, not assumptions about a newly supplied band. Each development stage has complete same-source fresh-clone Colab evidence. For the uniform endpoints the tested source is

`17ca395d4e9de992b1c575454a112da9e6f97e86`.

Its two runs agree in compiled object, raw oracle log and source-manifest hashes. The standalone budget lemma uses `propext, Quot.sound`; the other four uniform-module reports also use `Classical.choice`. No extra axiom is reported. Actual-log acceptance and three real-field rejection tests pass under normal and optimized Python. These tests concern evidence handling, not mathematical independence.

Short labels and an external declaration map replace long wrapped Lean names in this manuscript. The companion source map records exact names, source SHAs, and evidence directories. Reproduction commands remain in the existing copyable notebooks rather than being split into misleading line fragments. The fixed-map Schur criterion, its counterexample calculation and consumer specialization above are analytic or source-inspection arguments; the whole manuscript is not described as machine checked.

Model assessments and review context

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References

[1] L. Eriksson, *Exact-Kernel Fourier Families Obstruct Every Penalty Factored Through a Block Map in a Flat Lattice Gauge Form*, ai.viXra 2608.0015v1 (2026), AIRR ARR-2026-7EPM3V3DP796BBRR v1. `https://airr.science/papers/ARR-2026-7EPM3V3DP796BBRR/versions/v1/`. Historical import, not peer reviewed or assessed by AIRR; checked 30 October 2026.

[2] J. Dodziuk, *Finite-difference approach to the Hodge theory of harmonic forms*, American Journal of Mathematics **98** (1976), 79–104. `https://doi.org/10.2307/2373615`. Institutional source: `https://academicworks.cuny.edu/gc_pubs/180/`.